



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

HOW 'GLOBAL' WAS BRITAIN'S TRANSFORMATION BETWEEN 1450 AND 1750?

*KS3: Early Modern World & Global Encounters
(1450–1750)*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: Who held global power in 1450?				
L2: How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?				
L3: Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?				
L4: James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?				
L5: Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle				
L6: Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift				
L7: What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?				
L8: How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?				
L9: How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: Who held global power in 1450?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze why 15th-century Western Europe was an impoverished, isolated periphery.
- ☐ Evaluate the geopolitical impact of the Ottoman capture of Constantinople in 1453.
- ☐ Forensically compare the wealth of Ming China and West African empires with Western Europe.

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Select *THREE* terms that share a close historical connection. Identify which *ONE* remaining term is the 'Odd One Out' in this lesson, and explain your historical reasoning:

Ming Dynasty | Ottoman Empire | Songhai Empire | Silk Roads | Fall of Constantinople (1453) | Eurocentrism

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], analyze the chain of catalysts that locked Western Europe into rural isolation before 1450.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], analyze the chain of catalysts that locked Western Europe into rural isolation before 1450.

STAGE 1 1348–50

Demographic Devastation

The Black Death wipes out 30–50% of the European population, shattering rural labour markets.



STAGE 2 1337–1453

Dynastic Exhaustion

The Hundred Years' War drains the treasuries of England and France in destructive continental conflict.



STAGE 3 c. 1450

Commercial Impoverishment

Explain why European kingdoms could not directly buy Asian goods with domestic agricultural produce:



STAGE 4 1453

The Outer Periphery

Europe remains an isolated fringe, producing no manufactured exports desired by Asian merchants.

Causal Analysis: Explain the export deficit:

Q2. Using paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], evaluate and rank the four decisive drivers that forced European monarchs into the Atlantic.

Using paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], evaluate and rank the four decisive drivers that forced European monarchs into the Atlantic.

A Ottoman Control of Constantinople (1453 siege severing Christian overland access to the Silk Roads)

B Insatiable Aristocratic Demand (Desperate elite need for Asian pepper, silk, and spices to preserve status)

C Ottoman Military Superiority (Mehmed II's siege artillery proving European land armies could not retake the Levant)

D Crushing Venetian & Ottoman Customs Duties (Extravagant transit taxes making overland Asian imports unaffordable)

TOP CATALYST

#1 []

Contributing Contributing

#2 []

#3 []

Minor

#4 []

Justify your Rank 1 selection: Why was this factor the primary catalyst for Europe turning to the Atlantic?

Q3. Using Source C, Source D, and paragraphs [3.1]–[3.3], contrast European economic marginality with Afro-Asian imperial wealth.

Using Source C, Source D, and paragraphs [3.1]–[3.3], contrast European economic marginality with Afro-Asian imperial wealth.

Western European Realities (The Periphery)	Afro-Asian Imperial Realities (The Core)
• Over 90% of population bound to rural subsistence farming eating bland oat pottage [1.2].	• Mansa Musa of Mali commanding vast gold reserves, depressing Cairo gold value for a decade [3.1, Source C].
• Demographic collapse from the Black Death and devastation from the Hundred Years' War [1.1].	• Kingdom of Benin building 10,000 miles of earthwork walls and sophisticated bronze metallurgy [3.2, Source D].
• Virtually zero gold reserves and no manufactured exports desired by Asian merchants [1.3].	• Ming Dynasty China commanding 100m people with compass, gunpowder, and printing monopolies [3.3].
• Completely severed from overland Silk Road transit routes following the 1453 Ottoman conquest [2.3].	• Admiral Zheng He sailing 400ft multi-deck Treasure Fleets across the Indian Ocean [3.3].

Historical Audit: Why does comparing primary evidence from Benin, Mali, and China decisively shatter the Eurocentric myth of 1450?

Q4. Enquiry Essay: "To what extent is it historically accurate to describe Western Europe in 1450 as an impoverished, powerless periphery compared to the great empires of Asia and Africa?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (European Periphery & Poverty): Argue that Europe was weak and impoverished, citing peasant living conditions, demographic collapse, and the Ottoman blockade of Constantinople [1.1–1.3, 2.3].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (Afro-Asian Superpowers): Demonstrate that real wealth and technology lay in Asia and Africa, citing Mansa Musa's Malian gold, Benin bronze engineering, and Zheng He's Chinese Treasure Fleets [3.1–3.3, Sources C & D].
- Historiographical Verdict: Evaluate Pomeranz's thesis: Was Europe's later oceanic voyage driven by civilizational superiority or desperate geographic and commercial weakness?

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"From an archival perspective, describing Western Europe in 1450 as an impoverished periphery is highly accurate because..." • "As demonstrated in paragraph [1.2] and Source A, the vast majority of Europeans..." • "Furthermore, the 1453 Ottoman conquest of Constantinople proved that..." • "Conversely, the great imperial centers of Africa and Asia commanded unmatched wealth, as evidenced by..." • "In China, the technological sophistication of the Ming Dynasty was demonstrated by..." • "Ultimately, in evaluating the balance of global power in 1450, modern historians like Pomeranz argue that..."

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

L2: How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how the Protestant Reformation shattered European religious unity.
- ☐ Analyze the strategic significance of Spanish silver and maritime navigation technology.
- ☐ Forensically investigate Elizabethan privateering dispatches.

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose *TWO* terms from the word bank. Write *ONE* grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (*because, although, or consequently*):

Protestant Reformation | Indulgence | Treaty of Tordesillas (1494) | Privateer | Spanish Armada (1588) | Circumnavigation

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], map how religious schism transformed European exploration into global naval conflict.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], map how religious schism transformed European exploration into global naval conflict.

STAGE 1 1517

The Ninety-Five Theses

Martin Luther challenges papal corruption, triggering the Protestant Reformation across Europe.



STAGE 2 1534

English Reformation

Henry VIII passes the Act of Supremacy, severing England from the Roman Catholic Church.



STAGE 3 1494–1570

Papal Monopoly Contested

Explain why Protestant England refused to obey the papal division of the globe:



STAGE 4 1588

The Catholic Crusade

King Philip II sends the Spanish Armada to overthrow Protestant England and restore Catholicism.

Causal Analysis: Explain Protestant rejection:

Q2. Using Source D and paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], analyze how royal portraiture was weaponized as religious and imperial propaganda.

Using Source D and paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], analyze how royal portraiture was weaponized as religious and imperial propaganda.



Source D: *The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I* (1588, attributed to George Gower), celebrating the defeat of the Spanish invasion fleet.

1 The Hand upon the Globe

Elizabeth's right hand rests firmly upon the Americas. Explain the imperial message conveyed to Catholic rivals:

2 Storms Shattering the Catholic Armada

Behind Elizabeth, the stormy sea wrecks the Spanish fleet. Explain the religious interpretation of the 'Protestant Wind':

Q3. Interrogate the diplomatic protest dispatch sent by King Philip II's ambassador Bernardino de Mendoza to Queen Elizabeth in 1580.

“The Queen of England has received the pirate Drake with high honor, who hath plundered our sovereign’s subjects contrary to the law of nations, and she hath taken the stolen bullion into her own tower, defying the holy decree of the Apostolic See which gave these seas to the Crown of Spain.”

1. In the source excerpt above, underline or circle the decisive phrase that reveals the key historical evidence.

2. Analytical Explanation: Why was the phrase 'defying the holy decree of the Apostolic See' the crucial ideological dividing line between Catholic Spain and Protestant England?

Q4. Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the escalation of English exploration in the 16th century driven more by religious conflict than by commercial greed?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (Religious Ideology): Argue that religious conflict drove exploration, citing the Protestant rejection of the Treaty of Tordesillas, the Armada invasion, and anti-Catholic ideology [1.3, 3.3, Source D].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (Commercial Greed & Silver Plunder): Counter-argue that raw commercial profit was the true motivator, citing Potosí silver, Drake's £600,000 plunder, and Elizabeth funding the Crown through piracy [2.1, 3.1, 3.2].
- Historiographical Verdict: Weigh the competing arguments: Did religious rhetoric merely disguise state piracy, or was religious survival the existential engine of naval expansion?

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"On one hand, religious conflict was unquestionably a decisive catalyst because..." • "As evidenced in paragraph [1.3] and Source A, Protestant England completely rejected..." • "Furthermore, the 1588 Armada proved that maritime conflict was framed as an existential holy war..." • "Conversely, revisionist historians argue that commercial greed was the primary driver because..." • "As demonstrated in paragraph [3.2], Drake's plunder of Spanish silver yielded..." • "Ultimately, in evaluating 16th-century exploration, religious zeal and commercial greed were inextricably linked because..."

L3: Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how the invention of the joint-stock company funded overseas English colonization.
- ☐ Evaluate the complex encounter between English settlers at Jamestown and the Powhatan Confederacy.
- ☐ Forensically contrast English corporate propaganda with indigenous reality.

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:

**Joint-Stock Company | East India Company (EIC) | Royal Charter | Factory (Trading Post) |
Mughal Empire | Jamestown (1607)**

Power, Governance & Warfare

Economy, Trade & Society

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], analyze the sequence through which corporate profit mechanisms led to overseas colonization.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], analyze the sequence through which corporate profit mechanisms led to overseas colonization.

STAGE 1 1600–06

The Joint-Stock Innovation

Private London merchants pool capital to fund high-risk oceanic voyages without royal debt.



STAGE 2 1606

Royal Charters Issued

King James I grants corporate monopolies over Virginia and the Indian Ocean trade.



STAGE 3 1607–10

The Starving Vulnerability

Explain why early English corporate outposts were completely dependent upon indigenous survival aid:



STAGE 4 1614–22

The Tobacco Monoculture

Profitable cash-crop farming forces settlers to seize vast indigenous tribal lands by military force.

Causal Analysis: Explain indigenous dependence:

Q2. Evaluate the calculated geopolitical dilemma confronting Chief Powhatan as English settlers established Jamestown.

Evaluate the calculated geopolitical dilemma confronting Chief Powhatan as English settlers established Jamestown.



Option A: Military Annihilation: Total Extermination of Jamestown

Mobilize thousands of warriors to overrun the fragile wooden fort, kill all settlers, and eliminate the European threat permanently before reinforcements arrive.



Option B: Commercial Alliances: Subordination through Trade & Tribute

Allow the weak settlement to survive, trade surplus corn for advanced English iron tools and copper, and incorporate the English as a subordinate tributary tribe.

Calculated Risk: Why was Powhatan's decision to embrace commercial trade a catastrophic long-term miscalculation for his people?

Q3. Using Source A, Source B, and paragraphs [3.1]–[3.3], cross-reference English corporate propaganda with indigenous archival reality.

Using Source A, Source B, and paragraphs [3.1]–[3.3], cross-reference English corporate propaganda with indigenous archival reality.

English Corporate Propaganda (Virginia Company)	Indigenous & Environmental Reality (Chesapeake)
• Promotional pamphlets advertising Virginia as an abundant, fertile paradise of gold and easy wealth [1.1].	• Appalling mortality: 80% of English settlers dying of typhoid, dysentery, and starvation in the 1609 Starving Time [2.1, 2.3].
• Portrayal of colonization as a benevolent Christian civilizing mission, exemplified by Pocahontas in English dress [Source B].	• Complete early dependence upon Chief Powhatan's sophisticated agricultural surplus for survival [2.2].
• Enormous commercial tobacco profits remitted to wealthy London joint-stock investors [3.1].	• Rapid environmental destruction and soil exhaustion driven by rapacious tobacco monoculture [3.2].
• Legal claims that Native Americans were nomads who did not own or improve the land [3.2].	• Vicious warfare and systematic expropriation of Powhatan agricultural lands leading to the 1622 war [3.3].

Historical Audit: Why did the commercial boom in tobacco make peaceful coexistence between English settlers and Native Americans completely impossible?

Q4. Enquiry Essay: "To what extent did early English overseas settlements transform from peaceful commercial trading ventures into predatory colonial conquests?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (Commercial Origins & Vulnerability): Argue that early settlements began as vulnerable commercial ventures dependent on trade, citing joint-stock funding and Powhatan corn aid [1.2, 2.2, Source A].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (Predatory Dispossession & Total War): Counter-argue that settlements quickly transformed into violent territorial conquests, citing tobacco soil exhaustion, land seizures, and the 1622 war [3.2, 3.3].
- Historiographical Verdict: Weigh the Seeley thesis vs. the Tharoor/Dunbar-Ortiz critique: Was imperial conquest an accidental outcome or an inevitable consequence of capitalist expansion?

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"On one hand, early English overseas settlements initially appeared to be purely commercial ventures because..." • "As evidenced in paragraph [1.2] and Source A, Jamestown was funded not by the Crown, but by..." • "Furthermore, during the first years of settlement, the English were completely dependent upon..." • "Conversely, post-colonial historians argue that commercial settlements quickly revealed their predatory nature because..." • "As demonstrated in paragraph [3.2], the explosive profitability of tobacco caused..." • "Ultimately, in evaluating whether the empire was accidental or predatory, a historian must recognize that..."

L4: James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the religious grievances and state oppression confronting English Catholics under James I.
- ☐ Evaluate the forensic mechanics and logistics of the 1605 Gunpowder Plot.
- ☐ Forensically scrutinize the Monteagle Letter and Guy Fawkes's torture confessions.

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:

Recusant | Divine Right of Kings | Undercroft | The Rack | Penal Laws | State Entrapment

"In 1605, King James I abandoned the Divine Right of Kings and rewarded every Catholic Recusant with seats in Parliament, completely eliminating the need for Penal Laws."

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace the escalation of religious tension that culminated in the Gunpowder Plot.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace the escalation of religious tension that culminated in the Gunpowder Plot.

STAGE 1 1559–1603

Elizabethan Penal Laws

Recusancy fines and the execution of Catholic priests drive Catholic worship underground.



STAGE 2 1603

Jacobean Succession

James I ascends the throne; Catholics harbor short-lived hopes of religious tolerance.



STAGE 3 1604

The Broken Promise

Explain why James I reinstated harsh anti-Catholic laws in 1604:



STAGE 4 1604–05

Catesby's Radical Cell

Despairing Catholic gentry conclude that only the total destruction of the state can save their faith.

Causal Analysis: Explain royal reversal:

Q2. Using paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], evaluate and rank the four primary drivers behind the Gunpowder Treason.

Using paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], evaluate and rank the four primary drivers behind the Gunpowder Treason.

A Crushing Recusancy Penal Laws (Financial ruin and legal oppression of Catholic families)

B Catesby's Radical Charismatic Leadership (Vision of an apocalyptic Midlands Catholic rebellion)

C Military Explosives Expertise (Fawkes's Spanish combat training enabling the 36-barrel plan)

D Betrayal of Royal Tolerance Promises (James I reversing his pledges to appease Puritan MPs)

TOP CATALYST

#1 []

Contributing Contributing

#2 []

#3 []

Minor

#4 []

Justify your Rank 1 selection: Which factor was the indispensable catalyst for the plot?

Q3. Interrogate the exact wording of the anonymous Monteagle Letter delivered on 26 October 1605.

“My lord, out of the love I bear to some of your friends, I have a care of your preservation. Therefore I would advise you to devise some excuse to shift your attendance, for God and man have concurred to punish the wickedness of this time; and think not slightly of this advertisement, but retire yourself into your country, for they shall receive a terrible blow this Parliament.”

1. In the source excerpt above, underline or circle the decisive phrase that reveals the key historical evidence.

2. Analytical Explanation: Why did the chilling phrase 'they shall receive a terrible blow this Parliament' immediately reveal to Robert Cecil that an explosive detonation was planned rather than an armed sword mutiny?

Q4. Enquiry Essay: "Was the 1605 Gunpowder Plot primarily a genuine Catholic terrorist conspiracy, or a crisis manufactured and manipulated by the state to destroy English Catholicism?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (Genuine Catholic Conspiracy): Argue that the plot was a genuine, desperate Catholic conspiracy, citing penal laws, Catesby's radical leadership, and Fawkes's military explosives [1.2, 2.1, 2.2].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (State Manipulation & Cecil's Surveillance): Counter-argue that Robert Cecil manipulated and timed the crisis, citing state gunpowder monopolies, the delayed cellar search, and political benefits to the Crown [3.1, 3.2, 4.3].
- Historiographical Verdict: Weigh the Fraser vs. Edwards debate: Did Cecil orchestrate the plot from scratch, or simply nurse a real conspiracy to its dramatic climax?

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"From an orthodox historiographical standpoint, the Gunpowder Plot was indisputably a genuine Catholic conspiracy because..." • "As evidenced in paragraph [2.1] and Source B, Robert Catesby assembled..." • "Furthermore, Guy Faukes's extensive experience as a Spanish mercenary proved that..." • "Conversely, revisionist historians present compelling evidence that Robert Cecil manipulated the crisis because..." • "As demonstrated in paragraph [3.2], Cecil's decision to delay searching the undercroft suggests..." • "Ultimately, in evaluating whether the plot was genuine or manufactured, the most balanced conclusion is that..."

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

L5: Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the ideological conflict between Divine Right monarchy and Parliamentary privilege.
- ☐ Deconstruct the visual propaganda surrounding the trial and execution of Charles I.
- ☐ Forensically analyze the Death Warrant and Charles I's scaffold speech.

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Select *THREE* terms that share a close historical connection. Identify which *ONE* remaining term is the 'Odd One Out' in this lesson, and explain your historical reasoning:

Personal Rule | Divine Right of Kings | New Model Army | Regicide | The Commonwealth | Levellers

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], evaluate the competing historical explanations for why war erupted in 1642.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], evaluate the competing historical explanations for why war erupted in 1642.

Whig View: Principled struggle for constitutional liberty against royal tyranny

Revisionist View: Functional breakdown of royal finance and Scottish crisis



Plot your position with an 'X' on the line, then explain your reasoning:

Q2. Using Source B and paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], deconstruct the contemporary visual record of the public regicide.

Using Source B and paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], deconstruct the contemporary visual record of the public regicide.



Source B: Contemporary 1649 broadsheet engraving depicting the public execution of King Charles I outside the Banqueting House at Whitehall, London.

1 The Severed Head Held Aloft

The masked executioner holds the King's severed head, shouting 'Behold the head of a traitor!' Explain the political significance:

2 The Fainting & Groaning Crowd

Witnesses recorded a colossal collective groan from the crowd. Explain what this reveals about public sentiment:

Q3. Interrogate the decisive sentence from King Charles I's scaffold speech delivered on 30 January 1649.

"It is not for the people to have a share in government; that is nothing pertaining to them. A subject and a sovereign are clean different things. And until you restore the rights of the Crown, the people will never enjoy their own."

1. In the source excerpt above, underline or circle the decisive phrase that reveals the key historical evidence.

2. Analytical Explanation: Why did Charles I's declaration that 'a subject and a sovereign are clean different things' confirm to the Parliamentarians that he could never be trusted as a constitutional monarch?

Q4. Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the execution of King Charles I in 1649 a principled act of constitutional justice rather than an illegal military murder?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (Constitutional Justice & Tyranny): Argue that the execution was an act of justice, citing the 11 Years' Tyranny, illegal Ship Money, starting the Second Civil War, and the principle that rulers are subject to the law [1.2, 2.2, 3.1].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (Illegal Military Coup): Counter-argue that it was an unlawful military murder, citing Pride's Purge, the Rump Parliament, the abolition of the House of Lords, and Charles's constitutional defense [2.3, 3.2, Source C].
- Historiographical Verdict: Weigh the Hill vs. Morrill debate: Did the trial establish the modern rule of law, or was it a military dictatorship operating under a legal charade?

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"From a constitutional perspective, the execution of Charles I was justified by Parliamentarians as an act of justice because..." • "As evidenced in paragraph [1.2], Charles demonstrated his disregard for the law by ruling for eleven years without..." • "Furthermore, John Bradshaw's indictment established the revolutionary legal principle that..." • "Conversely, revisionist historians argue that the trial was fundamentally an illegal military coup because..." • "As demonstrated in paragraph [2.3], the trial was only made possible through Pride's Purge, which..." • "Ultimately, in evaluating whether the regicide was justice or murder, a historian must conclude that..."

L6: Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how the Glorious Revolution of 1688 established constitutional monarchy and parliamentary supremacy.
- ☐ Analyze the mechanics of the 1690s Financial Revolution and the Bank of England.
- ☐ Forensically contrast traditional landed wealth with emerging liquid financial capital.

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

Mercantilism | Navigation Acts | Fiscal-Military State | Bank of England | Royal African Company | Consumer Revolution

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace the escalation that led from the Restoration to the permanent establishment of parliamentary supremacy.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace the escalation that led from the Restoration to the permanent establishment of parliamentary supremacy.

STAGE 1 1660

The Stuart Restoration

Charles II returns to the throne, restoring the monarchy after eleven years of Puritan military rule.



STAGE 2 1685–88

Catholic Absolutism

James II attempts to rule without Parliament and promote Catholicism, alarming the Protestant elite.



STAGE 3 1688

The Dutch Intervention

Explain why English Protestant nobles invited a foreign Dutch army to invade England:



STAGE 4 1689

The Bill of Rights

William and Mary accept constitutional monarchy, permanently subordinating the Crown to Parliament.

Causal Analysis: Explain the 1688 invasion:

Q2. Using paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], evaluate and rank the four decisive financial mechanisms that enabled Britain's global military expansion.

Using paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], evaluate and rank the four decisive financial mechanisms that enabled Britain's global military expansion.

A The Bank of England (1694 institutional foundation managing paper currency and state credit)

B The Parliamentary National Debt (Creditor confidence allowing the state to borrow at ultra-low 3% interest)

C Existential Threat of Louis XIV's France (Military necessity forcing Parliament to modernize state finance)

D City of London Capital Markets (Merchants pooling liquid wealth into stocks, insurance, and bonds)

TOP CATALYST

#1 []

Contributing Contributing

#2 []

#3 []

Minor

#4 []

Justify your Rank 1 selection: Why was this pillar the primary foundation of Britain's economic rise?

Q3. Using Source A and paragraphs [3.1]–[3.3], cross-reference the characteristics of traditional landed wealth against emerging financial capital.

Using Source A and paragraphs [3.1]–[3.3], cross-reference the characteristics of traditional landed wealth against emerging financial capital.

Traditional Landed Aristocratic Wealth	Emerging City Financial Liquid Capital
• Wealth defined entirely by hereditary country estates and agricultural soil [3.2].	• Wealth based on liquid paper instruments: banknotes, government bonds, and company shares [2.2, 3.2].
• Income derived from collecting seasonal rents from rural tenant farmers [3.2].	• Trading global imperial commodities: sugar, tobacco, tea, and enslaved people [3.1].
• Political power anchored in local shire influence and the House of Lords [3.2].	• Headquartered in London institutions: Bank of England, Royal Exchange, and Lloyd's Coffee House [2.2, 3.1, Source A].
• Suspicious of paper money, viewing merchant financiers as corrupt stock-jobbers [3.2].	• High financial volatility: massive speculative windfalls and catastrophic crashes like the 1720 Bubble [3.3].

Historical Audit: Why did the rise of liquid financial capital permanently shift political power away from rural manors towards the City of London?

Q4. Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the Glorious Revolution and Financial Revolution a triumph for British constitutional freedom rather than a victory for a wealthy commercial oligarchy?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (Constitutional Freedom & Rule of Law): Argue that the 1688–1694 settlement established genuine constitutional liberty, citing the Bill of Rights, the end of Divine Right, property security, and low-interest state credit [1.3, 2.3, 4.2].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (Commercial Oligarchy & Exclusion): Counter-argue that it established an exclusionary oligarchy, citing the voting restriction to 5% of men, the South Sea Bubble corruption, and the protection of financial capital over human welfare [3.3, 4.3].
- Historiographical Verdict: Weigh the North institutional thesis against the Thompson critique: Did the settlement create modern liberty, or an entrenched oligarchic state?

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"From an institutional perspective, the Glorious Revolution represented a monumental breakthrough for constitutional liberty because..." • "As evidenced in paragraph [1.3], the 1689 Bill of Rights legally ended..." • "Furthermore, economic historians like Douglass North argue that parliamentary control of taxation established..." • "Conversely, radical historians emphasize that the 1688 settlement established an exclusive oligarchy because..." • "As demonstrated in paragraph [4.3], fewer than five percent of the population possessed..." • "Ultimately, in evaluating the 1688–1694 settlement, one must conclude that while it established the architectural foundations of constitutional liberty, its immediate beneficiaries were..."

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

L7: What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the three stages of the Triangular Trade and the gun-slave cycle along the West African coast.
- ☐ Analyze the forensic evidence of physical and psychological brutality during the Middle Passage.
- ☐ Evaluate the industrial reality of Caribbean sugar plantations and the Eric Williams capital accumulation thesis.

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:

Triangular Trade | Middle Passage | Barracoon | Chattel Slavery | The Plantation Complex | Branding

Power, Governance & Warfare

Economy, Trade & Society

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace how British industrial production fueled human commodification on the West African coast.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace how British industrial production fueled human commodification on the West African coast.

STAGE 1 Leg 1 (Outward)

Industrial Export

British ships depart Bristol and Liverpool loaded with manufactured cloth, brass pans, and Birmingham muskets.



STAGE 2 West Africa

The Gun-Slave Cycle

Firearms are traded for war captives, incentivizing militarized raids and destabilizing African inland societies.



STAGE 3 Castle Barracoons

Depersonalization & Imprisonment

Explain how captive Africans were branded and imprisoned before being forced through the Door of No Return:



STAGE 4 Leg 2 & 3

Plantation Returns

Surviving captives produce sugar and tobacco in the Caribbean, shipped back to Britain to generate vast merchant capital.

Causal Analysis: Explain the branding and dungeon conditions:

Q2. Study Source B and paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3]. Identify and analyze the four forensic features of this technical blueprint that exposed the reality of tight-packing.

Study Source B and paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3]. Identify and analyze the four forensic features of this technical blueprint that exposed the reality of tight-packing.

Q3. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[3.3] and Source C, cross-examine the human costs of commodification against the imperial capital accumulated by Britain.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[3.3] and Source C, cross-examine the human costs of commodification against the imperial capital accumulated by Britain.

Column A	Column B
• Branding with red-hot irons (RAC) and imprisonment in suffocating Cape Coast barracoons [1.3].	• Massive exports of Birmingham muskets, brass, and textiles stimulating British domestic manufacturing [1.1].
• 454 captives compressed into 16-inch spaces on the Brookes with 12–20% mortality on the Middle Passage [2.2, 2.3].	• Enormous fortunes accumulated by merchant elites in Bristol and Liverpool, funding civic docks and mansions [1.1].
• Violent separation of mothers, fathers, and children during Kingston harbour Scramble auctions [3.1, Source C].	• Cheap sugar, rum, and tobacco flooding into British consumer markets and fueling the coffeehouse revolution [3.3].
• 18-hour gang labour under the whip and fatal amputations in boiling houses, resulting in life expectancy under 10 years [3.2, 3.3].	• Plantation profits capitalized major British financial institutions, including Barclays and Lloyds [4.2].

Historical Audit: Why do plantation ledgers and shipping records prove that Britain's 18th-century commercial rise was fundamentally subsidized by human commodification?

Q4. Enquiry Essay: "To what extent were the mechanics and profits of the Transatlantic Slave Trade the decisive driving force behind Britain's 18th-century economic transformation?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (Industrial Mechanics & Human Commodification): Explain how the Triangular Trade functioned as an industrialized commercial apparatus, citing Birmingham manufacturing, Cape Coast Castle barracoons, and the tight-packing of the Brookes [1.1–1.3, 2.1–2.3, Sources A & B].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (The Eric Williams Capital Thesis): Analyze how Caribbean plantation fortunes and sugar profits capitalized British banking, shipping ports, and industrial ventures [3.1–3.3, 4.2, Source C].
- Historiographical Verdict: Weigh the Williams thesis against modern economic counter-arguments (Eltis/Anstey regarding domestic innovation vs Atlantic commercial infrastructure) to reach a balanced judgement [4.2–4.3].

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"From an economic and archival perspective, the Transatlantic Slave Trade functioned not merely as commerce, but as a calculated industrial machinery that..." • "As demonstrated in paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3] and Source A, British domestic manufacturing was intimately linked to..." • "Furthermore, the forensic evidence of the 1788 Brookes blueprint (Source B) illustrates that..." • "In evaluating the financial impact, Trinidadian historian Eric Williams decisively argued that..." • "Conversely, modern economic historians like David Eltis qualify this argument by pointing out that..." • "Ultimately, while domestic innovation was crucial, Britain's 18th-century economic transformation was inextricably anchored in..."

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4] **Marks:** / 16 **Teacher Target:**

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

L8: How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze the spectrum of covert and daily resistance deployed by enslaved people on Caribbean plantations.
- ☐ Evaluate how Queen Nanny and the Jamaican Maroons defeated British forces to secure sovereign freedom.
- ☐ Assess the historical agency of Olaudah Equiano and the Sons of Africa in shifting British public opinion.

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:

Spectrum of Resistance | Maroons | Covert Resistance | Guerrilla Warfare | Sons of Africa | Abolitionism

"Enslaved Africans submitted passively to their conditions without resistance, and the Maroons were loyal British soldiers who helped plantation owners enforce strict order."

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace how resistance evolved across every phase of the Transatlantic slave system.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace how resistance evolved across every phase of the Transatlantic slave system.

STAGE 1 Coastal Dungeons

Spiritual Refusal

Captives in coastal barracoons refuse food and throw themselves into ocean surf, believing spirits return to Africa upon death.



STAGE 2 Middle Passage

Shipboard Insurrections

Enslaved captives launch armed revolts at sea; over 500 documented ship mutinies force crews to carry heavy artillery.



STAGE 3 Caribbean Estates

Covert Sabotage

Explain how enslaved workers secretly damaged sugar mill gears, feigned sickness, and preserved spiritual rituals:



STAGE 4 Maroons & Metropole

Sovereignty & Abolition

Maroons establish independent mountain communities while Black abolitionists in London publish devastating eyewitness memoirs.

Causal Analysis: Explain covert daily sabotage and cultural resistance:

Q2. Evaluate the agonizing strategic choice faced by Cudjoe and Queen Nanny when British Governor Trelawny offered the 1739 peace treaty.

Evaluate the agonizing strategic choice faced by Cudjoe and Queen Nanny when British Governor Trelawny offered the 1739 peace treaty.

Q3. Analyze the forensic excerpts from Thomas Thistlewood's plantation diary (Source A) and Equiano's bestselling autobiography (1789).

1. In the source excerpt above, underline or circle the decisive phrase that reveals the key historical evidence.

Q4. Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the resistance of enslaved Africans, rather than white parliamentary politicians like Wilberforce, the decisive factor in exposing and challenging the Transatlantic Slave Trade?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (On-the-Ground Resistance & Military Defiance): Analyze how covert sabotage, Queen Nanny's Maroons, and armed rebellions made slavery economically precarious and militarily unsustainable [1.1–1.3, 2.1–2.3, Sources A & B].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (Black Intellectual Agency & Eyewitness Testimony): Explain how Olaudah Equiano and the Sons of Africa mobilized public opinion and proved Black intellectual equality [3.1–3.3, Source C].
- Historiographical Verdict: Evaluate the Beckles revisionist thesis against the traditional Wilberforce narrative: Who was truly decisive in bringing down the slave system [4.1–4.3, Source D]?

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"From an archival and historiographical perspective, attributing the downfall of the slave trade solely to white politicians is fundamentally flawed because..." • "As documented in paragraphs [1.2] and Source A, enslaved labourers actively engaged in..." • "Furthermore, the military triumphs of Queen Nanny and the Jamaican Maroons proved that..." • "In the British metropole, Black agency was exemplified by Olaudah Equiano, whose autobiography..." • "Conversely, traditional historians emphasize the legislative role of William Wilberforce, yet..." • "Ultimately, modern historians like Hilary Beckles conclude that parliamentary action was merely the final reaction to..."

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

L9: How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Synthesise political transformations from absolute divine right monarchy to parliamentary oligarchy following the 1689 Bill of Rights.
- ☐ Contrast imperial mercantile wealth and global trade with domestic urban squalor and the Bloody Code.
- ☐ Construct a sustained historiographical evaluation judging whether Britain was truly 'modern' by 1750.

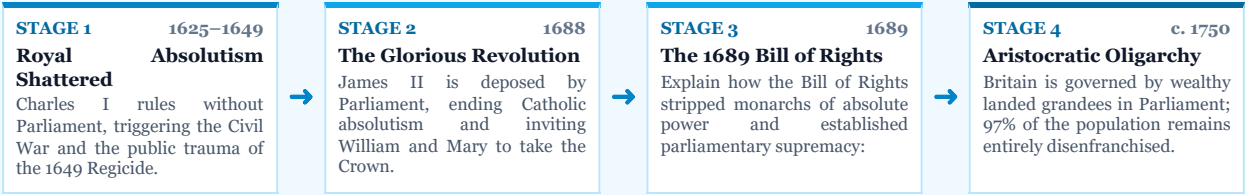
Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Select *THREE* terms that share a close historical connection. Identify which *ONE* remaining term is the 'Odd One Out' in this lesson, and explain your historical reasoning:

Constitutional Monarchy | Rotten Borough | The Bloody Code | Gin Craze | Urbanisation | Enlightenment

Q1. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace how violent constitutional upheaval created Britain's 18th-century parliamentary oligarchy.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[1.3], trace how violent constitutional upheaval created Britain's 18th-century parliamentary oligarchy.



Causal Analysis: Explain the constitutional limits on the Crown:

Q2. Using paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], evaluate and rank the four decisive drivers of Britain's transformation into a global superpower.

Using paragraphs [2.1]–[2.3], evaluate and rank the four decisive drivers of Britain's transformation into a global superpower.

A Naval Supremacy (The Royal Navy's 250+ warships securing oceanic trade routes against France and Spain)

B The Financial Revolution (Bank of England 1694, National Debt, and Lloyd's insurance mobilizing vast capital)

C Colonial Plantation Extraction (Astronomical wealth from Caribbean sugar, Virginia tobacco, and slave trafficking)

D Vibrant Civic & Print Culture (Over 500 coffeehouses, daily press, and the birth of modern public opinion)

TOP CATALYST

#1 []

Contributing Contributing

#2 [] #3 []

Minor

#4 []

Q3. Using paragraphs [1.1]–[3.3] and Sources A, B, and C, cross-examine the modern institutional achievements against the brutal domestic and colonial realities.

Using paragraphs [1.1]–[3.3] and Sources A, B, and C, cross-examine the modern institutional achievements against the brutal domestic and colonial realities.

Column A	Column B
• 1689 Bill of Rights ending divine autocracy and establishing constitutional rule of law [1.2, Source A].	• Aristocratic oligarchy: less than 3% of the population could vote in corrupt pocket boroughs [1.3].
• Financial Revolution: Bank of England, National Debt, and Lloyd's global marine insurance [2.2].	• Imperial prosperity anchored directly in the human horror of the Transatlantic Slave Trade [2.2].
• Vibrant urban civic culture with 500+ coffeehouses and free press circulating news [2.3].	• Catastrophic urban squalor, infant mortality over 75%, and the despair of the Gin Craze [3.1, 3.2, Source C].
• The Royal Navy and global mercantile empire connecting Britain to Asian and Atlantic trade [2.1, Source B].	• The Bloody Code: over 200 capital offenses and public executions at Tyburn protecting private property [3.3].

Historical Audit: Why does comparing both columns prove that Britain's 1750 'modernity' was deeply fractured and contradictory?

Q4. Synoptic Capstone Essay: "To what extent had Britain transformed into a truly 'modern' society between 1450 and 1750?"

ANALYTICAL STRUCTURE GUIDE:

- PEE Paragraph 1 (From Peripheral Weakness to Global Hegemony): Contrast the impoverished agrarian outpost of 1450 with the naval, financial, and commercial superpower of 1750 [Acts 1 & 2, Source B].
- PEE Paragraph 2 (Constitutional Rule of Law vs Aristocratic Oligarchy): Analyze the 1689 Bill of Rights, evaluating whether it created genuine liberty or protected elite property [1.1–1.3, Source A].
- PEE Paragraph 3 (The Dark Underbelly of Modernity): Examine the systemic exploitation that powered Britain: the Transatlantic Slave Trade, the Bloody Code, and Hogarth's Gin Lane [3.1–3.3, Source C].
- Historiographical Verdict: Evaluate the Whig interpretation of progress against modern revisionist critique: Was 1750 Britain genuinely 'modern', or a predatory empire of contradictions?

SENTENCE STARTERS & CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

"Across the 300-year arc from 1450 to 1750, Britain's transformation was undeniably revolutionary, yet fundamentally contradictory..." • *"In stark contrast to the impoverished, isolated Eurasian periphery of 1450, by 1750 Britain commanded..."* • *"Politically, the 1689 Bill of Rights (Source A) established constitutional milestones, yet..."* • *"However, the assertion that 1750 Britain was an enlightened modern society is shattered by the reality of..."* • *"As William Hogarth's Gin Lane (Source C) vividly illustrates, domestic urban squalor..."* • *"Ultimately, while traditional Whig historians celebrated Britain's inevitable progress, revisionist scholarship proves that..."*

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Early Modern World (1450–1750)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)